

Worker Marketplace App

Business Plan — Kenya Launch

Executive concept: A digital marketplace connecting employers with local workers, initially focusing on hospitality and casual workers such as barmaids, waiters, bartenders, cleaners and similar roles. Workers can create profiles and search for jobs for free. Employers can search and hire workers, while paying for premium information such as verified employment history, references and advanced recruitment tools.

1. Executive Summary

The business is built around **trust + convenience**: help employers find suitable workers faster while giving them additional confidence through verified employment information.

2. Problem

Employers often recruit through word of mouth, social media, informal referrals or personal networks. This can make hiring slow and makes it difficult to verify previous experience. Workers may also struggle to discover opportunities outside their personal networks.

- Employers struggle to verify previous experience and references.
- Suitable workers can be difficult to discover quickly.
- Workers depend heavily on personal networks to find jobs.
- Informal hiring creates uncertainty about reliability and experience.
- Employers need a faster way to compare candidates.

3. Solution

Create a mobile-first marketplace where workers create free profiles, employers search or publish jobs, employment information can be verified, and employers pay to unlock detailed employment history and premium recruitment tools.

4. Target Market

Workers: barmaids, waiters, bartenders, cleaners, kitchen staff and other hospitality/casual workers.

Employers: bars, restaurants, hotels, clubs, cafés, catering companies, event businesses and small businesses that frequently hire service workers.

Launch strategy: start in one major urban market, build density, then expand geographically and into additional job categories.

5. Product

- Worker registration and profiles
- Employer accounts
- Search and filters
- Job posting and applications
- Worker/employer messaging
- Ratings and reviews
- Phone, identity and business verification
- Employment-history verification
- Paid access to detailed employment history

- Notifications and admin dashboard

6. Business Model

Use a freemium model. The basic marketplace remains free enough to attract workers and employers. Revenue comes from employers who need deeper information or advanced hiring tools.

Revenue stream	Example pricing	Purpose
Single history unlock	KSh 50–150	One candidate
Profile unlock bundle	KSh 500+	Several workers
Employer subscription	Monthly	Frequent recruiters
Featured job	Paid listing	More visibility
Advanced recruitment	Premium plan	Extra hiring tools

7. Competitive Advantage

- Verified employment history
- Local worker discovery
- Availability status
- Worker and employer ratings
- Fast hiring for service-sector roles
- Simple mobile-first experience

8. Go-to-Market Strategy

Phase 1 — Build supply: Recruit workers through social media, hospitality networks, referrals, training institutions and direct outreach. Free registration removes the barrier to joining.

Phase 2 — Recruit employers: Approach bars, restaurants, hotels, clubs, cafés and event companies. Offer free employer accounts.

Phase 3 — Monetize: Once there is enough worker supply and employer activity, introduce paid employment-history unlocks and employer subscriptions.

Phase 4 — Expand: Add locations and job categories after achieving strong activity in the initial market.

9. Marketing

- TikTok, Instagram, Facebook and WhatsApp campaigns
- Worker referral rewards
- Partnerships with hospitality training institutions
- Direct recruitment in hospitality areas
- Employer outreach to bars, restaurants, hotels and clubs
- Free first job posting or introductory employer offer

10. Operations

- Customer support
- Worker and employer verification
- Employment verification

- Payment management
- Fraud and review moderation
- Product and technical maintenance

11. Technology Plan

A practical first version can be a mobile-first web app or cross-platform mobile app backed by a cloud database and payment service. The architecture should support profiles, search, messaging, payments, verification and an admin dashboard.

12. Illustrative Financial Model

The following example is for planning, not a forecast. Actual results depend on acquisition, pricing, conversion and operating costs.

Monthly activity	Example
Active employers	1,000
Employers making paid purchases	20% = 200
Average paid spend per paying employer	KSh 500
Illustrative transaction revenue	KSh 100,000/month
Subscriptions and featured listings	Additional revenue

13. Main Costs

- App/web development
- Cloud hosting and databases
- Payment processing
- SMS and notification services
- Verification services
- Customer support
- Sales and marketing
- Legal, privacy and compliance

14. Key Performance Indicators

- Registered workers
- Active employers
- Jobs posted
- Applications per job
- Employer-to-worker contact rate
- Successful hires
- Percentage of employers purchasing premium information
- Average revenue per paying employer
- Repeat employer rate
- Customer acquisition cost

15. Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Not enough workers or employers	Launch in a focused area and actively build both sides.
Fake employment histories	Verification, consent, audit trails and clear badges.
Low willingness to pay	Keep basic profiles useful and price premium access affordably.
Privacy concerns	Explicit consent, controlled access and appropriate data policies.
Fraud/scams	Phone/business verification, reporting, moderation and account controls.
Poor marketplace liquidity	Focus on one job category/location before expanding.

16. 12-Month Roadmap

Period	Focus
Months 1–2	Research, validate pricing, design product and build MVP.
Months 3–4	Pilot with workers and employers in one target market.
Months 5–6	Improve search, verification, payments and hiring workflow.
Months 7–9	Launch paid employment-history access and employer plans.
Months 10–12	Scale marketing, improve matching and prepare expansion.

17. Long-Term Opportunities

After traction, the platform could expand into reference checks, workforce management partnerships, training, employer subscriptions, staffing services and additional worker categories.

18. Recommended Starting Position

Start as a focused **hospitality worker marketplace** rather than trying to serve every occupation immediately. A concentrated market makes it easier to create enough workers and employers in the same place, which is critical for a two-sided marketplace.

Core message: “Find reliable workers near you — with verified experience when you need it.”